5. Green leafy vegetables
6. Non-leafy vegetables
7. Roots and tubers
8. Fruits
9. Milk and milk products
10. Animal foods—meat, fish, liver, egg etc
11. Carbohydrate foods
12. Condiments and spices

4.5 FUNCTIONS OF FOOD

Food has three main functions in the body



- Physiological
- Social
- Phychological

a) Physiological Functions

Food has three main physiological functions in the body

- Growth and Development
- Provision of Energy
- Repair and Maintenance of Cells

Growth and development



Food helps babies, young children and adolescents grow at a rapid rate. While in adults and the elderly people most growth has stopped and nutrients are required in maintaining healthy state.

Provision of Energy

As a car needs fuel for work, our body needs food to carry out daily tasks and regulate body's physiologic processes. When the body runs low on energy, humans feel fatigued and tired. In severe circumstances, a lack of energy may even lead to certain body processes shutting down. On the other hand, excess energy causes fat build up and can lead to obesity!

Repair and Maintenance of Cells

Good food is essential to maintain adequate health.

E.g, Skin is often cut or grazed, hair falls out constantly and body's red and white blood cells die on a regular basis.

By consuming the right nutrients, body will repair itself and stay healthy.

A healthy individual who eats well and exercise regularly is less likely to suffer from a cold or flu than a person who eats poorly and does not exercise.



b) Social Functions

Food is a symbol of hospitality and friendship throughout the world.

Food creates a relaxed atmosphere

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